

The ERP report said stock was available.

The warehouse knew it was not that simple.

A fictional but realistic question for NorthBridge Maintenance Supplies Ltd

57.33K Physical Stock	335.00 Quarantine Stock	24.17K Corrected Decision-Ready Stock	2.50K Discontinued Stock Qty
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The headline numbers showed stock in the business. The real question was how much of it could safely support a customer promise.

NorthBridge Maintenance Supplies Ltd had a familiar problem.

At management level, the ERP stock report suggested the business was broadly doing okay. There was stock on the system, stock by product group, and enough headline information to give the impression that availability was being managed.

But the warehouse team were less confident.

They were still checking bins manually, juggling delivery promises with sales, watching stock sit in quarantine, and seeing discontinued items continue to create noise in the system.

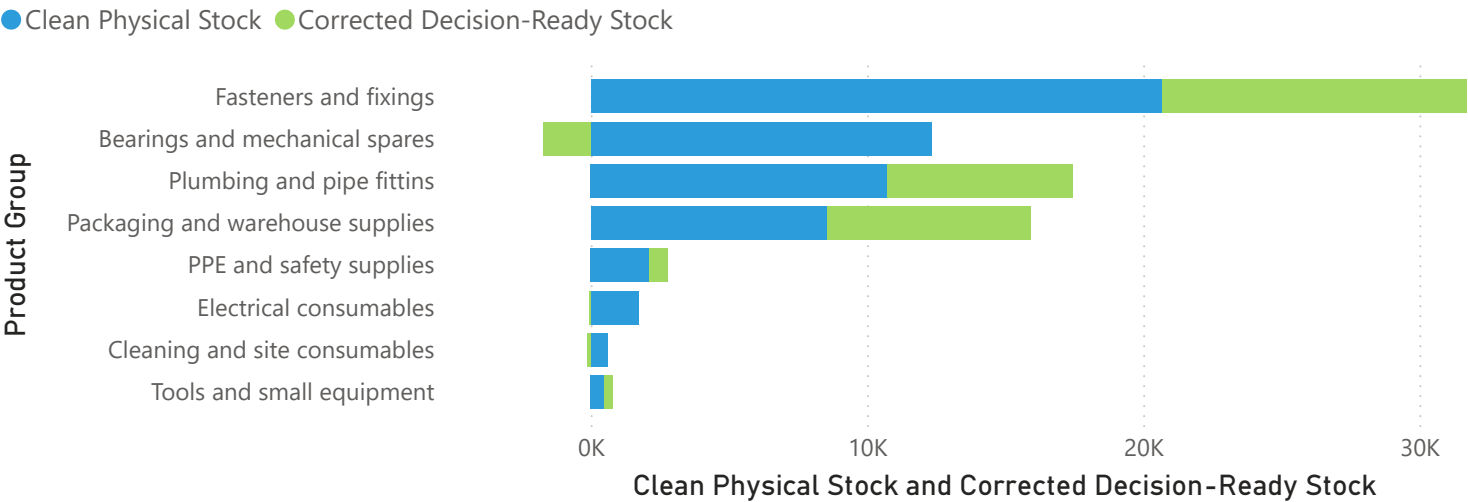
The question was not:
“Do we have an ERP stock report?”
The better question was:

“Can we trust this report enough to promise delivery from it?”

That is where the work started.

Physical Stock is not the same as Decision-Ready Stock.

Clean Physical Stock and Corrected Decision-Ready Stock by Product Group



The issue was not whether stock existed. The issue was whether the stock was usable, available, and safe to promise.

The first view looked reasonable.

NorthBridge had **57.33K clean physical stock**, but only **24.17K corrected decision-ready available stock**. It also had **335 units in quarantine** and **2.50K discontinued stock quantity**.

That difference matters.

A physical stock total can be useful for stock control and finance. But it does not answer the operational question sales and warehouse teams face every day:

“Can we safely promise this item to a customer?”

- To answer that, the report needed more context.
- Stock may be physically present, but already committed.
- It may be in quarantine.
- It may be discontinued.
- It may be in the wrong bin.
- It may depend on a supplier delivery that has not arrived yet.

The ERP report was not necessarily wrong. It was answering a narrower question than the business needed.

Some “safe” items were only safe before the operational checks

The useful part of the analysis came from comparing the original decision-ready view with the corrected view.

Two examples made the issue clear.

CC012 Blue Paper Roll originally showed **55 decision-ready units** and was flagged as **Safe to promise**. After correction, it moved to **-60 corrected decision-ready units** and became **Do not promise**.

EC075 Emergency Stop Button also moved from **55 decision-ready units** and **Safe to promise** to **-8 corrected decision-ready units** and **Do not promise**.

That is the trust gap.

The management view could say “stock available”.

The warehouse view knew there were still conditions attached.

Some of those conditions were small on their own: a miscount, a bin issue, an incorrect location, a delayed release, a discontinued item still sitting in the process. But together, they changed whether a customer promise was safe.

Item Code	Item Name	Decision-Ready Stock	Corrected Decision-Ready Stock	Stock Trust Flag	Stock Trust Flag After
BM003	V-Belt A32	-25.00	-25.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
BM021	Motor Coupling 25mm	-128.00	-128.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
BM058	Ball Bearing 6204	700.00	750.00	Check before promising	Check before promising
BM069	Taper Lock Bush	-260.00	-260.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
BM104	Roller Chain 1/2 Inch	-694.00	-694.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
BM161	Grease Cartridge	1,365.00	1,365.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
CC012	Blue Paper Roll	55.00	-60.00	Safe to promise	Do not promise
CC036	Industrial Degreaser 5L	-20.00	-20.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
CC056	Floor Cleaner 10L	0.00	0.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
CC075	Absorbent Pads Pack	-50.00	-50.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
CC095	Hand Sanitiser 5L	10.00	20.00	Check quarantine stock	Check quarantine stock
CC101	Heavy Duty Refuse Sacks	-25.00	-25.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
EC002	2.5mm Twin & Earth Cable	-145.00	-220.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
EC045	Cable Glands Pack	-25.00	-25.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
EC075	Emergency Stop Button	55.00	-8.00	Safe to promise	Do not promise
EC085	Junction Box IP65	-200.00	-200.00	Do not promise	Do not promise
EC102	LED Bulkhead Light	360.00	360.00	Check discontinued item	Check discontinued item
Total		24,363.50	24,170.50	Check quarantine stock	Check quarantine stock

The headline numbers showed stock in the business. The real question was how much of it could safely support a customer promise.

The correction reasons told the real story

The correction log showed why staff were not simply accepting the ERP report at face value.

The reasons included:

- incorrect warehouse representation
- miscounts
- quarantined stock released
- stock found in an incorrect bin

These are not just “data errors”.

They are operational signals.

If stock is returned to the wrong bin, the ERP may still show quantity, but the picker may not be able to find it.

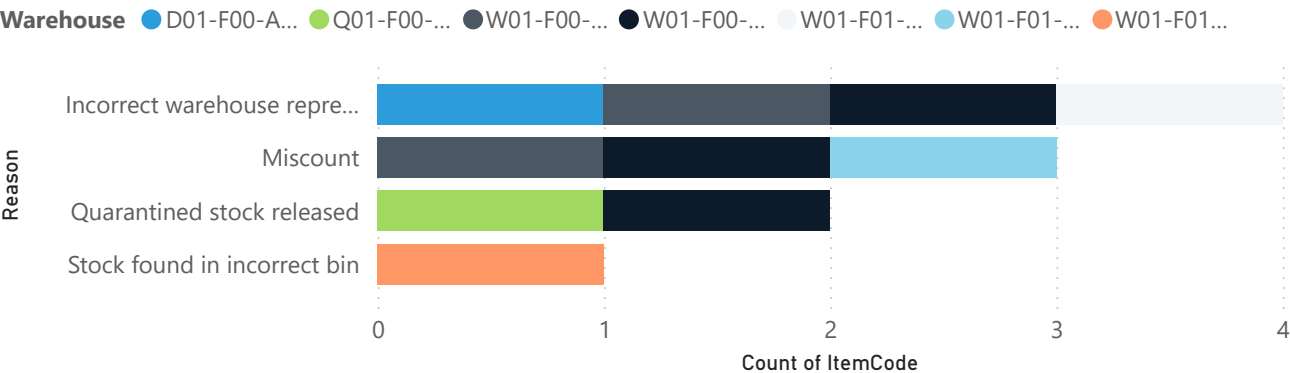
If stock is in quarantine, it physically exists, but it should not be promised until released.

If discontinued items remain active in the ordering process, the warehouse can be left carrying stock the business should be running down, not replenishing. If promised supplier deliveries are treated too confidently, sales may build promises on stock that is not yet available.

The warehouse team were not being awkward by checking the report.

They were protecting the business from promises the system could not fully support.

Count of ItemCode by Reason and Warehouse



ItemCode	Warehouse	OnOrder	Order Correction	Reason
CC012	W01-F00-A06-B05	50	100	partially used stock counted as whole
EC102	W01-F00-A02-B05	150	-150	Discontinued stock - cancelled order
PS006	W01-F00-A07-B01	0	50	Not-recorded order sheet found

The correction reasons explained why the ERP report still needed human checking before it could be trusted

What NorthBridge should do next

The aim is not to replace judgement with another dashboard.

The aim is to give judgement somewhere firmer to stand.

Issue found	Operational risk	Recommendation
Miscounts	Stock appears safer than it is	Introduce regular cycle counts for high-risk, high-movement, and close-to-reorder items
Incorrect bins or locations	Stock exists but cannot be found or picked reliably	Review bin discipline, returned stock handling, and uncharted locations
Quarantine delays	Physical stock is included too early in availability thinking	Keep quarantine stock separate from available-to-promise stock until released
Discontinued items still being ordered	Overstock, wasted space, and unnecessary process noise	Add order stops for discontinued items and use specials or clearance activity to reduce remaining stock
Supplier or inspection delays	Customer promises depend on stock that is not yet safe to use	Separate promised delivery dates from stock that is genuinely available to sell
Manual checking after the report	Time lost and confidence reduced	Build a safe-to-promise view that combines stock, commitment, quarantine, location, and status

The practical next step for NorthBridge is to create a stock view that separates:

- what is physically recorded
- what is already committed
- what is in quarantine
- what is discontinued
- what is below or close to reorder level
- what has recent correction history
- what can genuinely be promised

The report should not only show what exists.

It should show what the business can trust.

The StraightLine view

A report can be accurate and still not be useful enough. NorthBridge did not need more numbers first. It needed a clearer distinction between stock that existed in the system and stock that could safely carry a customer promise. That is where ERP reporting becomes decision support.

Good stock reporting does not remove judgement. It gives judgement somewhere safer to stand.